

EVOLUTION OF MICRO PROCESSOR

How did the micro processor come into being? From its earliest sightings to its use today in digital signages and ultrabooks. Here's an interesting infograph. <http://on.mash.to/sSpoux>

**JOBS, THE TWEAKER**

Malcolm Gladwell, author of *Blink and Tipping Point*, gives us his take on the biography of Steve Jobs. According to him, Jobs was more of a Tweaker than an Innovator. <http://nyr.kr/vQsywZ>

11 TECH SOUNDS THAT ARE GETTING EXTINCT

Here's presenting a host of sounds that you've probably never heard. Why, you ask? Because they're a dying species. Only a handful of them exist. <http://bit.ly/ujnuz4>

DESTRUCTION OF MEDIA

This article looks into the fact why we share a love-hate relationship with the media. Why is it that we love to trash it and can't seem to live without it at the same time. <http://bit.ly/u8Zd9l>



Barnes & Noble Nook Tablet

The best small tablet for reading books and magazines

- By Sascha Segan



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The reader's tablet is back. The new Nook Tablet delivers the best color e-reading experience available, especially for magazines and for childrens' books. It's a better e-reader than the Amazon Kindle Fire (\$199, 4 stars), our Editors' Choice for small tablets. But the Nook doesn't quite match the Fire on music, video or apps, and the Nook Color (\$199, 4 stars) offers the same great e-reading experience for less money. Make no mistake, the Nook is a very good small tablet, but the Fire delivers a better all-around tablet experience, and the Nook Color offers better value as a color e-reader.

Physical Design and User Interface

Feeling a little more 'book-like' than the Amazon Kindle Fire, the Nook Tablet is significantly taller and slightly wider at 8.1 by 5.9 by 0.5 inches (HWD) thanks to its much bigger bezel, but it's lighter at 14.1 ounces compared with Amazon's 14.6. There's a standard 3.5-mm headphone jack, and a curious little loop in the bottom left corner, which serves as both a handle and a way to conceal the reader's MicroSD card slot, just like on the Nook Color. In fact the Nook Tablet and the Nook Color are almost identical save for the a slightly lighter-color metallic finish. The Tablet has physical Power button and volume controls on the side

panels as well as a single, "N"-shaped home button at the bottom of the 7-inch, 1024-by-600 touch screen.

Barnes & Noble has made a big deal out of how its IPS LCD screen is less reflective than Amazon's, but after using both screens for long periods taking several photographs of each, I found I had to squint to tell the difference. It's there, but it's by no means pronounced enough to be a dealmaker. Both displays are much less readable in daylight than the e-ink screens on devices like the Amazon Kindle Touch (\$149, 4 stars).

The Nook Tablet, like the Amazon Kindle Fire, runs a very highly customized version of Android 2.3 on a TI OMAP4, 1GHz dual-core processor. But the Nook's user interface looks nothing like Amazon's (or, for that matter, Android's.)

Rather than shelves, here you have three free home screens where you can plunk down large icons representing your favorite books, magazines, or apps. (No widgets; this isn't standard Android.) Along the bottom of the screen are your most recently used items in a scrollable list, along with some links to promotional screens plugging B&N's various stores, and its favorite music and video related apps. (You can hide those links.)

Press the Home button, and you'll get seven main options: Home, Library, Shop, Search, Apps, Web and Settings. Your Library contains, on separate panes, Books, Magazines, Newspapers, Apps, Kids, and My Stuff, a catch-all for any of your own music, video or document files you may store in the Nook's 1GB of user-accessible



memory or on a MicroSD card up to 32GB. You can also create your own custom shelves within My Stuff to arrange books by topic, for instance.

Notice what's missing: Unlike on the Kindle Fire, the Nook lumps music and video under the catch-all of "Apps," and breaks out books, magazines, and newspapers more distinctly. That's actually on purpose, and it shows one of the major differences between the two tablets.

Barnes & Noble Is a Bookstore

Nobody beats Barnes & Noble when it comes to books. If childrens' books are going to be a